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Microfinance and Susu System

Client execution guide for a connected field, branch and member operation

HEAD OFFICE	BRANCH AND TOWN	FIELD AGENTS	MEMBERS
Sees the whole business	Runs the daily operation	Serve members in the community	Receive clear updates and make requests

A clear, practical view of how the platform will support the company, its teams and its members.

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1. The simple picture

This is one connected operating system for Susu savings first, with microcredit, hire purchase and welfare added in controlled stages. It gives every person the right view of the work they are responsible for, while keeping one central record of what happened.

Place	What it is for	What the person sees
Public website	Explain the company, products, branches and how to join.	Company information, branch contacts, package explanations, calculator, enquiry form and FAQs.
Agent Android app	Help paired field agents serve members and record a collection even when the network is poor.	Today's route, member search, collection screen, offline queue, cash handover summary and request forms.
Branch and head-office portal	Run branches, review requests, receive cash, close the day and oversee performance.	Dashboards, work queues, member records, cash controls, reports, cases and audit history.
Member SMS and USSD	Give members a simple way to receive proof and check or request services.	Receipts, reminders, balances, recent activity and request options when released.

The system is designed to record, control and explain the operation. In the initial release, cash is still collected and paid through the company's normal physical process. The platform does not automatically move money from a member's phone or bank account.

2. How the four sides communicate

Each person uses a different doorway, but nobody has a separate set of books. All important activity becomes part of the same central record, with the correct people notified or given a task.

MEMBER	AGENT PAIR	BRANCH	HEAD OFFICE
Pays, asks, checks and receives proof.	Records the visit and carries the collection to branch.	Receives cash, reviews requests and closes the day.	Monitors performance, risks, approvals and policy.

Practical flow: Member payment -> agent pair record -> member receipt after sync -> branch cash handover -> daily branch close -> bank deposit match -> management oversight.

- A member does not need a smartphone to be included. SMS and USSD support basic access.
- An agent can continue working during a poor network period; the app keeps a protected queue and sends the records when it reconnects.
- Branch and head-office users see the part of the operation that belongs to their role, not unrestricted access to every action.

3. A normal collection day

Step	What happens	Who sees the result
1. Visit	An agent pair meets the member and takes the physical payment according to the agreed collection process.	Agent pair records the visit; member sees the amount stated back to them.
2. Record	The agent selects the member, enters the amount and saves the collection. If offline, it waits safely in the phone until sync.	Agent pair sees a pending or synced status; branch sees it after sync.
3. Proof	Once the record reaches the central system, the member receives an SMS receipt where messaging is available.	Member receives proof; supervisors can see delivery or sync exceptions.

Step	What happens	Who sees the result
4. Handover	The agent pair hands cash to the branch cashier. Both sides record and confirm the handover.	Cashier, manager and head office see expected versus received cash.
5. Daily close	The branch counts cash, handles approved payouts, explains differences and closes the day.	Branch manager and finance team see the close status and any exception.
6. Bank match	The physical bank deposit is matched to the branch close. Differences remain visible until resolved.	Finance and management see a clear reconciliation trail.

4. At-a-glance responsibilities

Role	Main dashboard view	Main controls	What is deliberately blocked
Overall administrator	Whole-company collections, branch performance, major approvals, exceptions and trends.	Company rules, products, role assignments, oversight and high-level approvals.	Cannot quietly rewrite past money records or approve their own request.
Branch or town manager	Today's collections, agent activity, handovers, pending requests, branch close and local exceptions.	Manage assigned people and zones; approve within their authority; assign follow-up.	Cannot view or control another branch without permission; cannot exceed approval limit.
Branch cashier	Expected cash, agent handovers, approved payout queue, cash float and close checklist.	Confirm receipts and handovers; prepare approved payments; close cash count.	Cannot approve their own payout or change ledger history.
Supervisor	Agent pairs, routes, targets, missed activity, sync health and field checks.	Assign routes, coach agents, investigate flagged visits and escalate issues.	Cannot change a member balance or make a payment.
Field agent pair	Today's members, collection form, offline queue, cash summary and requests started.	Register within policy, record collection, issue request and submit handover.	Cannot delete a collection, pay out cash, approve loans or edit historical balances.
Member	SMS proof; later, USSD or PWA balance, recent activity and requests.	Check, request, report a problem and update permitted contact details.	Cannot transfer money or approve their own request through the initial member channels.

5. What the overall administrator sees

The overall administrator sees the business from above. This is not a screen for doing every transaction personally; it is a screen for knowing what is healthy, what needs approval and where action is needed.

Dashboard area	What it answers
Today at a glance	How much was collected, how many active agent pairs worked, what has been handed in, and which branches have not closed.
Branch comparison	Which towns or branches are on target, behind target, holding unusual cash or generating many exceptions.
Approval and exception queue	Which large withdrawals, loans, reversals, write-offs or policy exceptions require the right independent approval.
Risk and service watch	Which members have unresolved identity issues, which devices have concerns, which cases are overdue and where receipts or syncs are failing.

Dashboard area	What it answers
Reports and policy	Company performance, product settings, role assignments and exportable reports for management review.

The administrator can set policy and oversee people. They cannot make a past collection disappear, change a balance without a trace or self-approve an action that requires an independent checker.

6. What a branch or town manager sees

A branch or town manager has a practical daily view of their assigned operation. They see where field activity, cash and member requests need attention before they become problems.

On the manager dashboard	How it is used
Daily activity board	See expected collections, active agent pairs, visits not yet synced and members needing a follow-up.
Cash and handover board	Compare collections recorded, cash handed in, cash received and the branch close position.
Work queue	Review pending withdrawals, new loan or hire purchase requests, member updates and cases assigned to the branch.
People and coverage	See teams, zones, route performance, training needs and absent or inactive devices.
Branch health	See unresolved cash differences, delayed bank matches, complaints, KYC exceptions and overdue actions.

A manager can act only within an agreed branch and approval limit. The portal prevents self-approval, makes major actions require a second person and keeps a history of every decision.

7. What the field team sees and controls

Supervisor view

Supervisors focus on delivery in the field: which pairs are active, which routes have been missed, whether phones are syncing and where a spot check or coaching visit is required. They can guide and escalate. They do not alter balances or complete a cash payout.

Agent pair view

Screen	What the agent can do	Important guardrail
Today's work	Open assigned route, see member list and view a simple collection target.	Only assigned members and approved work appear.
Member search and profile	Find a member, confirm key details and see the information needed for service.	Sensitive data is limited to the task; full company records are not exposed.
Collection	Enter payment, save a receipt reference and continue when the network is unavailable.	A saved collection cannot be deleted or silently changed by the agent.
Offline queue	See items waiting to sync and resolve clear prompts after reconnecting.	The system detects duplicate or conflicting records before they enter the central record.
Cash handover	Review expected cash and start a handover to the assigned branch cashier.	Both parties must confirm the handover; differences create an exception.

Screen	What the agent can do	Important guardrail
Requests	Start a withdrawal, loan, hire purchase or welfare request for a member where that module is active.	Starting a request is not approval and does not release cash.

Agent access is limited to approved company devices. Phone fingerprint or face unlock can protect the agent's app access, but it is not a customer Ghana Card fingerprint reader.

8. What the customer sees and controls

The customer experience is intentionally simple. A member should understand what they paid, what was recorded and what is happening with any request without needing to visit a branch just to ask a basic question.

Member touchpoint	What the member sees or can do	What does not happen automatically
SMS receipt	Receive a receipt after a collection syncs, plus useful reminders and status updates.	A text message does not move money or approve a request.
USSD	Use a basic phone and PIN to check permitted information, see recent activity and start simple requests when released.	The initial USSD service is for checking and requesting, not sending or withdrawing money.
Member PWA	For smartphone members, view balance, activity, requests, notices and support options when released.	It does not bypass branch checks, identity controls or approval rules.
Support and complaints	Report a missing receipt, disputed entry, lost phone or service issue through a defined support path.	A complaint does not delete a record; it opens a tracked case for review.

The exact member screens are released in stages. The first practical promise is clear proof of collections and a controlled path to ask for help.

9. Identity, trust and a safe fallback

The Ghana Card is the primary identity source for member onboarding. Where provider approval and integration are in place, the process uses the appropriate NIA IVSP route, such as face verification or a supported biometric device. A normal Android phone fingerprint reader protects the agent's device; it does not provide a customer biometric template for national verification.

If verification is not successful	What happens next
1. Quality check	The user is guided to retry with better lighting, camera position or a clearer capture.
2. Approved alternative	Use a supported fingerprint or other approved IVSP route where available.
3. Escalation	The case is sent through the approved NIA or IVSP escalation process.
4. Controlled exception	The member is marked restricted and reviewed by compliance. No staff member gets an unrestricted override button.
NHIS information	A photo and details may be captured only as supporting information. NHIS is not the primary KYC basis.

10. Requests, approvals and disputes

Money-out actions and important changes should never depend on one person pressing one button. The system uses a clear maker-checker pattern: one authorised person starts or prepares an action, and a different authorised person checks and approves it.

Situation	How the system responds
Withdrawal or payout request	Member or staff starts the request; the correct branch role reviews it; an independent authorised role approves; the cashier pays only after approval; the record is finalised with proof.
Loan, hire purchase or welfare request	The request is captured, assessed by the responsible team, approved within policy and issued only after the required checks are complete.
Mistake or disputed collection	The case is logged, evidence is reviewed, and any correction follows an authorised reversal process. The original record remains visible in history.
Cash difference	The branch close cannot hide it. It stays open as an exception, is assigned to an owner and is escalated if not resolved.
Lost or replaced phone	The device is removed or re-bound through a controlled process before the user can continue.

11. What arrives first, and what follows

The full vision is deliberately delivered in stages. This gives the company time to test real field use, train people, correct processes and build confidence before more complex products are switched on.

Delivery stage	What is introduced	What remains for a later stage
Stage 0 - preparation	Rules, roles, products, branch setup, forms, data preparation, provider readiness and pilot training.	No live company-wide rollout until operating rules are confirmed.
Stage 1 - core Susu pilot	Branch portal, controlled agent app, member registration, core collection, SMS receipts, handover, daily close and basic management view.	Full credit, hire purchase, welfare and broad member self-service remain off until the pilot is accepted.
Stage 2 - controlled expansion	More branches and agent pairs, member USSD access, stronger exception management, commission and broader reporting.	Expansion is paced by readiness, not just by calendar date.
Stage 3 - credit and hire purchase	Loan workflows, credit assessment, hire purchase catalogue, approvals, repayment tracking and arrears handling.	Only introduced after core cash and reconciliation controls work reliably.
Stage 4 - welfare and hardening	Welfare workflows, richer reports, operational refinements, resilience testing and wider rollout.	Future mobile-money payment integration is a separate scoped project, not an assumption in the first release.

12. What this system will and will not do

It will	It will not
Give each role a clear dashboard and task queue. • Create a central, traceable record of collections, handovers, approvals and cases. • Support field work through an offline-capable Android app. • Give members receipts and simple service access.	Replace the company's cash handling policy or make physical cash disappear. • Allow staff to erase historic money activity without an audit trail. • Turn a request into a payout without the correct approval. • Treat an NHIS card photo as primary KYC or treat a phone fingerprint as customer national biometric verification.

13. What we need to agree before build starts

- The pilot branch or town, the first agent pairs and the named operational owners.
- Susu product rules, collection cycles, withdrawals, approval limits, fees and exception handling.
- The physical cash handover, daily close and bank deposit process that the system will reflect.
- The identity verification provider path, company device policy and how restricted KYC cases are handled.
- Which later-stage modules are committed after the pilot: USSD, member PWA, loans, hire purchase and welfare.
- Training dates, a pilot acceptance checklist and the decision point for expanding to the next branch.

Commercial pricing, provider charges and the managed support arrangement are intentionally handled in the separate commercial proposal. This guide explains the operating picture and the scope boundaries that inform that proposal.

14. Closing picture

The intended outcome is not simply a collection app. It is a disciplined operating picture: members get proof and a voice; agents get a practical field tool; branches get control of cash and work; and management gets visibility without compromising the checks that protect the business.

We begin with a working Susu pilot, prove the daily journey in one real branch, and grow from that foundation in controlled stages.